

that can be used by professional developers to build enterprise grade applications or products.

Different types of low-code platforms

Low-code platforms cater to different use cases. Depending on the intended usage or purpose, these can be classified as follows.

- **General-purpose:** These platforms can create virtually any type of product or application. With a general-purpose platform, users can build software that serves a wide variety of needs and can be deployed on cloud or on-premise.
- **Process:** These platforms focus specifically on software that runs business processes such as forms, workflows or integrations with other systems.
- **Request handling:** Request handling low-code platforms are similar to process-based low code, but are less capable. They can only handle processing requests for fixed processes.
- **Database:** Database low-code platforms are useful if users have large amounts of data that needs to feed into a system, without spending a lot of time on the task.
- **Mobile application development platform (MADP):** These platforms help developers code, test, and launch mobile applications for smartphones and tablets.

Key features of generic low-code platforms

General-purpose enterprise low-code development platforms support rapid software development, deployment, execution and management using declarative, high-level programming abstractions such as model-driven and metadata-based programming languages, and one-click deployments.

The key features supported by general-purpose low code platforms are as follows.

- **Visual modelling:** These platforms have a comprehensive visual modelling capability, including business processes, integration workflows, UIs, business logic, data models, Web services, and APIs.
- **Databases:** Support for a visual editor, Excel sheet import or use of existing data models from a different database.
- **Pre-built templates:** Support a variety of pre-built templates that can serve as a starting point to get an application up and running quickly. Using a well designed and tested template not only increases productivity but also helps in building a more reliable and secure application.
- **Integration:** Provide easy integration with external enterprise systems, databases, and custom apps.
- **Security and scalability:** The right low-code platform makes it easy to create enterprise grade software that is secure and scalable.
- **Metrics:** Support for gathering metrics and monitoring the software.
- **Life cycle management:** Support for version management and ticket

management, as well as Agile or scrum tools.

- **Reusability:** The code generated is reusable and can integrate easily with general-purpose IDEs, with multi-platform support for testing and staging.
- **Deployment options:** Ability to deploy on public or private clouds with support for container images. Also support preview functionality before publishing to the cloud.
- **Licensing:** Flexible licensing models with no vendor lock-in.
- **Others:** The platforms include other services, such as project management and analytics.

Generic low-code platforms for professional developers

The main objective of a generic low-code platform is to help reduce the time spent by a developer working on a product as compared to traditional hand coding. Using visual interfaces, drag-and-drop modules, and more, these low-code platforms reduce the manual effort of coding largely, but will need some coding requirements for completely building a product.

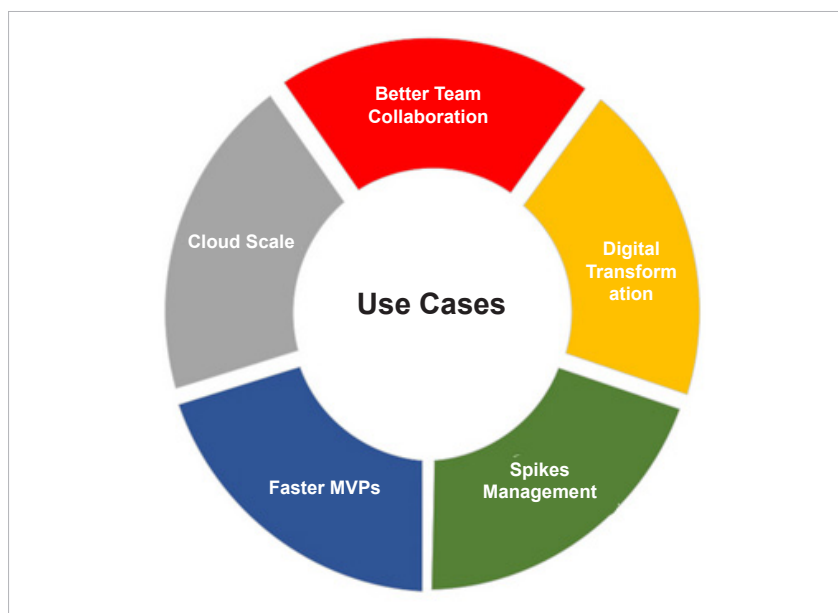


Figure 1: Important use cases of low code